FREE PRINTABLE RECIPE CARDS

Grandma's *Christmas Baking*

Old-fashioned favourites for cookie trays, family dinners and cozy December afternoons.







1. Christmas Gumdrop Bars
2. Devil's Food Cake
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NO. 1



Christmas Gumdrop Bars

350°F (175°C) · 25 TO 30 MIN BAKE · MAKES 36 SQUARES

INGREDIENTS

- ⅓ cup butter or margarine
- ⅓ cup packed brown sugar
- ½ cup granulated sugar
- 2 eggs, beaten
- ½ teaspoon vanilla
- 1 cup all-purpose flour
- 1 cup rolled oats
- ½ teaspoon baking powder
- ½ teaspoon baking soda
- ¼ teaspoon salt
- ½ cup sweetened coconut
- ½ cup chopped gumdrops (no black ones!)
- Icing sugar, for dusting

METHOD

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F (175°C) and grease a 9 × 9-inch pan.
2. Cream the butter, brown sugar and granulated sugar together well.
3. Beat in the eggs and vanilla.
4. **Add the rest:** flour, salt, oats, baking powder, baking soda, coconut and chopped gumdrops. Mix it all together.
5. Press the mixture evenly into the pan.
6. Bake for 25 to 30 minutes, until golden.
7. When cool, sift icing sugar over the top and cut into 36 squares.

🌿 **Sage's Tip** Leave out the black gumdrops. Nobody has ever missed the licorice! And wait until the bars are completely cool before you add the icing sugar, so it sits on top like fresh snow.

Video & more: askthedancingsage.com/recipe-christmas-gumdrop-bars.html

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NO. 2



Devil's Food Cake

Grandma's old-fashioned chocolate layers

OVEN 350°F (175°C) · BAKES 30–35 MINUTES · TWO 8- OR 9-INCH ROUND PANS · ONE TWO-LAYER CAKE

INGREDIENTS

- ☐ ½ cup butter
- ☐ 1½ cups lightly packed brown sugar
- ☐ 2 eggs, well beaten
- ☐ ½ teaspoon vanilla
- ☐ 2 squares (2 oz) unsweetened chocolate, melted
- ☐ 1½ cups all-purpose flour
- ☐ 1¼ teaspoons baking soda
- ☐ ¾ teaspoon salt
- ☐ 1 cup plus 2 tablespoons milk

METHOD

1. **Prepare the pans:** Preheat the oven to 350°F (175°C). Grease two 8-inch or two 9-inch round cake pans and line the bottoms with parchment paper. Metal pans are recommended.
2. **Cream the butter and sugar:** Cream the butter. Gradually blend in the brown sugar, then beat until light and fluffy.
3. **Add the eggs:** Add the beaten eggs and vanilla. Beat until well combined.
4. **Add the chocolate:** Blend in the melted chocolate.
5. **Mix the dry ingredients:** Blend or sift together the flour, baking soda and salt.
6. **Combine:** Add the dry ingredients to the creamed mixture alternately with the milk, blending well after each addition.
7. **Bake:** Divide the batter between the prepared pans. Bake for 30–35 minutes.
8. **Cool:** Let the cakes cool in their pans for about 10 minutes, then turn them out onto a rack, peel off the parchment and cool completely before frosting.

🌿 **Sage's Tip** Bake the layers a day ahead if you like. Once they're completely cool, wrap them well and frost on the day you serve.

Video & more: askthedancingsage.com/recipe-devils-food-cake-peppermint-frosting.html

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NO. 3



Peppermint Seven-Minute Frosting

for the Devil's Food Cake

DOUBLE BOILER · 4–7 MINUTES OF BEATING · DOUBLE FOR A TWO-LAYER CAKE

INGREDIENTS

- ☐ ¾ cup sugar
- ☐ ⅛ teaspoon cream of tartar
- ☐ A few grains of salt
- ☐ 3 tablespoons cold water
- ☐ 1 unbeaten egg
- ☐ 3–4 drops peppermint extract (instead of vanilla)
- ☐ A little green food colouring, optional

This frosting recipe is enough for one 8- or 9-inch square cake. Double it to fill and frost this two-layer cake.

To finish

- ☐ Crushed candy canes, for the top (optional)

METHOD

The frosting

1. **Combine:** Combine the sugar, cream of tartar, salt, cold water and unbeaten egg in the top of a double boiler.
2. **Beat over boiling water:** Place over rapidly boiling water. Beat continuously with an electric beater until the frosting stands in stiff peaks, about 4–7 minutes. Scrape down the sides of the pan now and then.
3. **Flavour and tint:** Remove from the heat. Add the peppermint extract and, if you like, a little green food colouring.

Putting it together

1. **Fill and frost:** Place one cooled layer on your cake plate and spread with frosting. Top with the second layer, then swirl the rest of the frosting over the top and sides.
2. **Finish:** Scatter crushed candy canes over the top just before serving, if you like.

🌿 **Sage's Tip** Go easy on the peppermint, darling. Three drops is festive; ten drops is toothpaste. And a seven-minute frosting is at its fluffiest the day it's made, so frost the cake the day you plan to serve it.

Video & more: askthedancingsage.com/recipe-devils-food-cake-peppermint-frosting.html

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NO. 4



No-Bake Lemon Squares

NO OVEN · 20 MINUTES, PLUS OVERNIGHT CHILLING · 8 × 8-INCH PAN · 36 SMALL SQUARES

INGREDIENTS

Squares

- ☐ 36 whole graham crackers, divided into four layers of nine
- ☐ 1 can sweetened condensed milk
- ☐ ⅔ cup freshly squeezed lemon juice

Lemon glaze

- ☐ 1 cup icing sugar
- ☐ About 2 tablespoons freshly squeezed lemon juice
- ☐ 1 tablespoon milk, as needed to adjust consistency

Chocolate drizzle

- ☐ Chocolate chips, melted, enough for a light drizzle

METHOD

1. **Prepare the pan:** lightly dampen the bottom of an 8 × 8-inch pan with water to hold the lining in place. Line with parchment or wax paper, leaving an overhang for lifting out the squares.
2. **Mix the filling:** stir the sweetened condensed milk and ⅔ cup lemon juice together in a small bowl until thick and smooth. Watch it thicken all by itself, like magic. This makes about 1⅔ cups (400 mL) of filling.
3. **Make the layers:** arrange nine graham crackers snugly across the bottom of the pan. Spread a generous ½ cup of filling evenly over them. Repeat twice, then finish with the remaining nine crackers. You should have four cracker layers and three filling layers.
4. **Add the lemon glaze:** place the icing sugar in a small bowl. Slowly stir in the lemon juice until smooth and barely pourable. Add milk a little at a time, as needed, to adjust the consistency. Carefully spread over the top cracker layer.
5. **Drizzle with chocolate:** melt the chocolate chips and let them cool slightly. Spoon into a small food-safe resealable bag and press out the extra air. Snip a tiny piece off one corner and pipe a light zigzag over the glaze. Wobbly lines count as rustic.
6. **Refrigerate:** cover and chill for at least 10 hours or overnight so the crackers soften and the layers set.
7. **Cut and serve:** lift out using the paper overhang. Cut into a 6 × 6 grid to make 36 small squares. Keep refrigerated until serving.

> 🌿 **Sage's Tip** You do the layering; the fridge does the work! And use fresh lemons, please. The bottled stuff knows what it did.

Video & more: askthedancingsage.com/recipe-no-bake-lemon-squares.html

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NO. 5



Butterscotch Toffee Bars

375°F (190°C) · ABOUT 35 MINUTES, PLUS COOLING · 9 × 9-INCH PAN · 25 SQUARES

INGREDIENTS

Base

- ▢ 1 cup all-purpose flour
- ▢ 6 tablespoons packed brown sugar
- ▢ ⅛ teaspoon salt
- ▢ ½ cup butter, margarine or vegan margarine

Toffee topping

- ▢ 6 oz bar butterscotch toffee (English toffee)
- ▢ 1 tablespoon corn syrup
- ▢ 1 tablespoon water
- ▢ 2 tablespoons butter, margarine or vegan margarine
- ▢ ⅛ teaspoon salt
- ▢ ⅔ cup chopped walnuts

METHOD

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F (190°C).
2. **Make the base:** crumble the flour, brown sugar, salt and butter together in a bowl until well mixed. Get your hands right in there. Nobody's watching.
3. **Press and bake:** press the mixture into an ungreased 9 × 9-inch pan and bake for 10 minutes.
4. **Melt the toffee:** while the base bakes, put the toffee, corn syrup, water, butter and salt in a saucepan over low heat. Break up the toffee as it goes so it melts nice and speedy. (And yes, you may sneak a piece.)
5. Add the walnuts and pour the topping over the warm base, spreading it to the edges.
6. Bake again for 8 to 10 minutes.
7. Cool, then cut into 25 little squares… or 16. I won't tell.

🌿 **Sage's Tip** Keep the heat low when you melt the toffee. It's tempting to turn it up and hurry things along, but toffee scorches quickly, and smaller pieces melt faster anyway. Patience now, glossy squares later.

Video & more: askthedancingsage.com/recipe-butterscotch-toffee-bars.html

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NO. 6



Butter Tart Bars

350°F (175°C) · ABOUT 1 HOUR · 9 × 9-INCH PAN

INGREDIENTS

Base

- ▢ ½ cup butter, margarine or vegan butter
- ▢ ⅓ cup packed brown sugar
- ▢ 1¼ cups all-purpose flour

Butter tart filling

- ▢ 2 large eggs
- ▢ 1 cup packed brown sugar
- ▢ ¼ cup all-purpose flour
- ▢ ¾ teaspoon baking powder
- ▢ ¼ teaspoon salt
- ▢ 1¼ cups raisins
- ▢ ½ cup chopped walnuts

METHOD

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F (175°C).
2. **Make the base:** mix the butter, brown sugar and flour until crumbly. Press evenly into an ungreased 9 × 9-inch pan.
3. Bake the base for 10 minutes.
4. **Make the filling while the base bakes:** beat the eggs and brown sugar together, then stir in the flour, baking powder, salt, raisins and walnuts.
5. Spread the filling evenly over the warm base.
6. Bake again for about 30 minutes, until the top is golden brown and the centre is almost firm.
7. Cool completely in the pan before cutting into squares.

🌿 **Sage's Tip** Let them cool completely before you cut them. Warm butter tart filling has a mind of its own, and patience gives you neat squares instead of a delicious puddle.

Video & more: askthedancingsage.com/recipe-butter-tart-bars.html

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NO. 7



Chocolate Confetti Squares

NO OVEN · 15 MIN + CHILLING · MAKES 36 SMALL SQUARES

INGREDIENTS

- ¼ cup butter or margarine
- ½ cup peanut butter
- 1 cup semisweet chocolate chips
- 1 bag (250 g) miniature coloured marshmallows

METHOD

1. Melt the butter and peanut butter together in a large saucepan over low heat.
2. Stir in the chocolate chips until completely melted and smooth.
3. Remove from the heat and let the mixture cool until the bottom of the saucepan is comfortable to touch.
4. Gently fold in the coloured marshmallows until completely coated.
5. Press into a parchment-lined 9 × 9-inch pan.
6. Refrigerate until firm, then cut into squares.

🌿 **Sage's Tip** Make sure the chocolate mixture has cooled before adding the marshmallows. Otherwise, you'll end up with chocolate marshmallow soup!

Video & more: askthedancingsage.com/recipe-chocolate-confetti-squares.html

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NO. 8



Cornstarch Shortbread

300°F (150°C) · ABOUT 20 MIN BAKE · MAKES ABOUT 4 DOZEN

INGREDIENTS

- ▢ 1½ cups Becel Vegan margarine sticks
- ▢ 2 cups all-purpose flour
- ▢ 1 cup icing sugar
- ▢ 1 cup cornstarch
- ▢ ¼ teaspoon salt

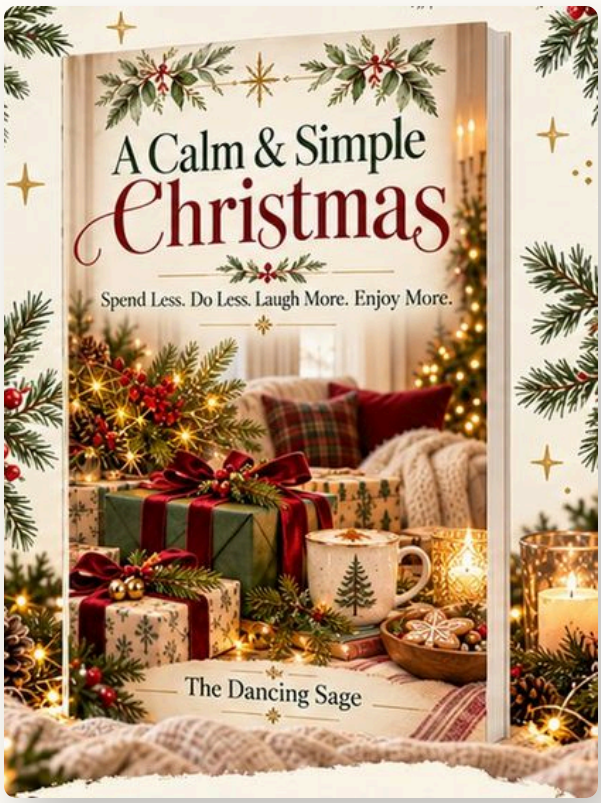
METHOD

1. Preheat your oven to 300°F (150°C).
2. Combine all the ingredients in a large bowl. Mix by hand until they come together into a soft dough.
3. Roll the dough into 1-inch balls and place them on a baking sheet.
4. Gently flatten each ball with a fork.
5. Bake for about 20 minutes. Keep them pale rather than waiting for a golden-brown top.
6. Let the cookies cool on the baking sheet before moving them. They are delicate while warm!

🌿 **Sage's Tip** Pale is perfect. The moment shortbread turns golden it starts heading toward hockey-puck territory.

Video & more: askthedancingsage.com/recipe-cornstarch-shortbread.html

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